



OBJECTION HANDLING MATRIX

HOW TO CRUSH OBJECTIONS
LIKE A PRO

Many salespeople often find themselves pulling their hairs when they reach that part of the sales call where they have to wrestle and grapple with objections. Deflecting those 'buts' and 'what-ifs,' trying to find the right words to say that'll switch a 'no' to a 'yes' is exhausting and can be a long, drawn-out process. And if you happen to say the wrong words, it could mean the end of everything that you've worked for in the last hour!

But here's the thing—objection handling doesn't have to be that difficult. In fact, if you know how to read between the lines and dissect your prospect's thinking process, wading through the sales call can be swift, easy, and painless.

Knowing how to handle objections is one of the most important parts of the sales process. In this resource, we make your sales call journey easier, helping you increase your close rates and get you to seven figures. These are the things we hope you will achieve upon reaching the end of this resource:

- **Understand the key concept behind objections.** Knowledge is crucial. You don't want to end up facing an unknown enemy. In this resource, we'll help lay down the foundations you need to have when handling objections.
- **Learn how to identify objections.** From the moment you enter a sales call, it's essential to know what kind of objections you're dealing with. In that way, guiding your prospect to the right mindset becomes less challenging.
- **Become a subject-matter expert.** Once you finish consuming this resource, you'll see a massive improvement in the way you deal with objections. You may even become the go-to guy in your team!

WHAT IS AN OBJECTION HANDLING MATRIX?

Not everyone understands the value of a good sales structure. As a result, they charge straight into a call and struggle with it for the next few hours. Unsure of how to unravel their prospects' minds, they end up wondering what to say if they suddenly start saying 'no,' or why they even say it at all! The objection handling matrix is created to help drill down, identify, and define objections. It's pretty much like peeling an onion. Not all are what they appear to be at first. You have to go through several layers to get to the root cause of why your prospect is reluctant to open their wallets. With this process, you can identify objections and learn how to deal with them.

	Logistical	Fear	Smokescreen
Money	Logistical, Money	Fear, Money	Smokescreen
'Think About It'	Logistical, 'Think About It'	Fear, 'Think About It'	
Partner	Logistical, Partner	Fear, Partner	

Fg.1 The Objection Handling Matrix (To hear an in-depth explanation about each objection, click on each of the links in the figure)

The matrix is composed of two different axes: fear & logistical, and 'think about it,' money, & partner. As you lean further away from the center of the graph, you'll notice that you move closer to the smokescreen objections. Objections are rarely composed of only one type. They can be a mix of two such as 'logistical, money,' 'fear, money,' 'fear, partner,' etc. Each of them will be explained in the next section. As you see, smoke-screen is neither a mix of two or more. And the reason for that is your prospect may try to use any of the objections listed, but none of them are real. So your job is to find out whether your prospect is only trying to escape the call or these objections are legitimate.

6 DIFFERENT TYPES OF OBJECTIONS

Most, if not all sales calls always involve handling objections. If your prospect gets sold in the first few minutes, great! But, bear in mind that not all sales calls are that easy. And knowing what type of objection you'll be dealing with is a crucial part of planning how you can turn that call into a sale. Here are the different types of objections you may meet when speaking to your prospect:

- **Fear-based objection.** Fear is an inherent part of human nature that directly affects decision making. We all get scared of something. But belittling that fear may only result in you losing that sale. Allow the prospect to come to the right conclusion themselves through a series of skilled questions, reframes, and analogies. This helps them look at their problems at a different angle.
- **Logistical objection.** This type of objection involves the movement of money. Most sales reps handle this type of objection badly because no one taught them how to identify and handle them like fear-based objections.
- **Money objection.** This is either a "proposition of value," ROI, or pure, logistical funds issue. Knowing that it's money is one side of the coin. Differentiating a fear-based, money objection and a logistical, money objection is critical as they are handled differently

- **Partner objection.** Some prospects may need to consult their spouses first before buying your product. Others only use this as an appeal to a third party authority currently absent to avoid a real objection. Whatever the case may be, it's essential to treat it as a real "partner objection" first.
- **'Think About It' objection.** This type of objection can be tricky. For the most part, it can be about money. However, you have to dig deep and identify whether it's about money, value, results, etc. In this scenario, it's best to address the logistical element first before going after the fear element.
- **Smokescreen objection.** These are just "better luck next time" situations. There is either a lack of need or desire on behalf of the prospect. They just don't want to say NO, so they give a series of smokescreens to avoid the "confrontation." Unfortunately, in this kind of objection, there is no win for you at all! The trickiest part is how to identify it to eventually smoke out this type of objection and not waste more time.

Your sales call objection can be either one of these or a mixture of two or more.

Gaining a better understanding of the nature of your prospect's objection can get you one step closer to creating a better plan to close that call.

OBJECTION HANDLING STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

“What do I say?” “When should I start pitching the call?” “What if their partner doesn’t want them to do it?” These are questions often thrown by sales reps inside the production floor. Tricky, the objection handling process may be, but it certainly is no rocket science. And the key to successfully overcoming objections is to not think of them as objections, but rather as problems to solve.

Here, you’ll be learning how to deal with both logistical-based objections and fear-based objections.

The Objection-Handling Matrix Flow Chart

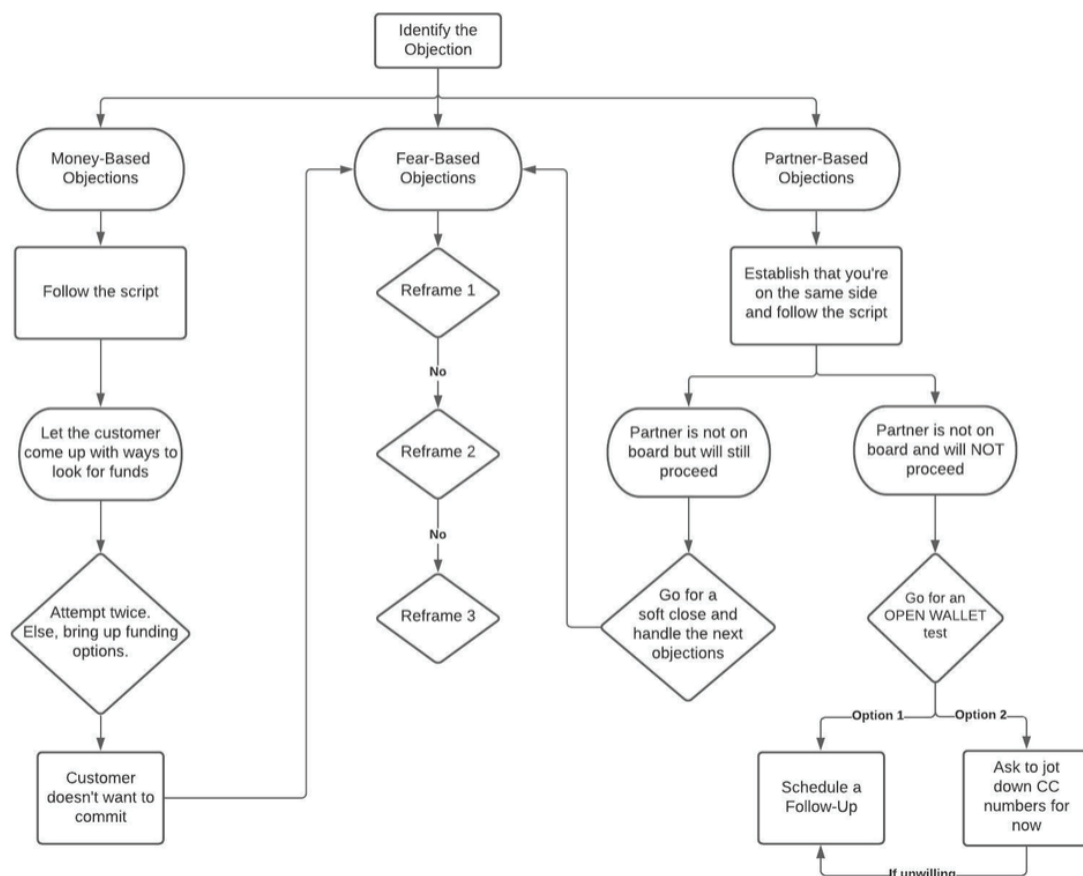


Fig. 2 The Objection Handling Matrix Flow Chart

This is the typical flow of the objection handling matrix. It starts off with identifying which type of objection it is, and then ends with either a close, a follow-up, or several reframes. Sometimes, you have to go through several hoops before you can make a sale. But one thing that's sure is through a solid framework, knowing which path to take and what words to say makes handling objections a whole lot easier.

After you have identified the type of objection/s that your customer may be making, try to poke them to the right direction through this process:

Partner-Based Objections (Spousal Support)

Step 1. Get on the same side of the table.

"Okay. So, if your partner was here right about and all for it, then would this possibly be the answer for you?"

Okay. But why? What specifically do you think is the element that gives you most benefit?

Okay. So, How does your ___ feel about you having the right skills to make sure that your business does \$___ in the next 12 months?

Okay. Well, what are you going to do if they don't want you to invest in the program so that you can get to that level financially in the next 12 months?

Well, how are you going to get there if you don't have these skills?"

Step 2. Is the partner on board? Or not? There are only two results in this scenario. If they say the partner isn't on board but your prospect is willing to do it, then go for a soft close and handle the next objections. By then, you are able to determine that it's a fear-based objection.

If they say that if their partner is not on board, they will NOT proceed, then most likely, they do need approval from their spouses first. Ask how they will speak to the partner, and coach them on how to bring it up through problems and impacts, not solutions. That's when you go for the Open Wallet test.

The 'Open Wallet' Test

This test allows you to determine if the prospect is willing to provide their card information even without the permission of their partners.

Check out this script as reference:

"Okay. So we have a couple of options to move forward from here. We can either schedule a follow up, or option 2 is that we put down CC numbers. We don't do this to "hold your spot" or anything bullshit like that. We do it as an emotional commitment to moving forward on your goals. We find that when you go to your partner with giving some form of commitment, but that it respects them enough to give them the opportunity to be part of the decision making process. But you have a level of certainty and commitment that comes through. So, how would you like to proceed? What is the best way for you to know that when you hit the bed tonight, you are doing your best to hit the *XYZ goal?" *XYZ can be substituted for any goal that you've agreed upon with the prospect.

Step 3. If still unwilling, then schedule the follow-up. It may be best to speak at another time, this time with the partner present. So hold the fort and don't give up just yet.

Money Objections (Lack of money Concern)

Step 1. Help the prospect come up with solutions on how to fund themselves.

Remember, always think of an objection as a problem that you need to solve. In that case, try to help the prospect solve their money problem without you having to tell them what to do.

“Tell me if you did have the funding, is this something that would work for you?”

Most will say yes.

Why do you feel it would though?

Okay. So, I can see that money might be an issue from what you told me. How do you think you can resolve that? Where can you find funding to get the training and coaching to actually get you where you want to go with your business?”

Step 2. Let them come up with the solution on their own. If the prospect is unable to provide a solution to their problem, ask them with this question:

“What other avenues do you have to find funding to get your business up to 500k in the next 12 months? Plug in what they want”

Step 3. Plant the idea of using credit. If the prospect is still unable to come up with a solution, introduce them to the idea of putting it on credit.

“Have you ever considered putting it on a credit card or PayPal credit and just paying it off with the extra profits you make in your business from the training here?”

Step 4. If the prospect refuses to do so, bring up funding options. Otherwise, start the fear-based objection handling sequence.

FEAR-BASED OBJECTIONS

We can handle all the fear-based objections in a similar way. For as long as we have identified that it's fear, then the logistical-based ones have been handled. All we need to do now is to create a perspective shift. Here are a few ways to do that:

Reframe #1: Change of Process

Salesperson: Okay. So, I can understand that this is a big move for you and that you might need to think about it or take some time. Can I ask you a question? Do you feel your mindset affects your decision-making process?

Prospect: Yes, of course.

S: Okay. And are you 100% with where you are at with XYZ right now?

P: Well, no.

S: Okay, And do you want that decision making process to dictate your results moving forward?

P: No, I don't.

S: Why not?

Reframe #2: The Island Analogy

"Maybe I can explain myself a bit better. Imagine you are on an island surrounded by water. You live there, work there, etc. All you can see around you is 17.1 miles in every direction, and all there is is water. So ALL of your decisions are made with that in mind. The perspective you have shapes your decisions. But, to see the world for what it really is, then you have to be on top of a mountain. So the REALLY difficult thing is, first, believing the mountain is there. And once you know it is, then taking the leap of faith, and picking a direction to start walking. We have been walking around the island for a while, and it might be time to pick a direction. Strap on the boots and start making decisions like the guy who is ALREADY ON THE MOUNTAIN. So, what do you feel like you NEED to do to put yourself in the best position to get the outcomes that you want?"

Reframe #3

“We all make decisions based on our perspective. But the hardest thing is making decisions based on where we WANT to be. The overweight person is only overweight because they MAKE the CHOICES that an overweight person makes. They have a fundamentally flawed decision-making process around health, fitness and nutrition. It is not UNTIL they make the decisions of a fit and healthy person that they BECOME a fit and healthy person. Do you get what I mean? So what choices do you need to start making to get the perspective that you WANT to have?”

WHY SALES SNIPER AND THE OBJECTION HANDLING MATRIX?

Matt has been selling for more than 12 years for some of the best sales coaches and fitness membership programs. The methods he uses have been built through battle-tested strategies that he gathered through years of experience, and will continue to evolve as the market continues to shift. For years, he has seen several salespeople get into a call without any real plan on how to handle objections, one of the most important and trickiest parts of a sales call. As a result, the team only ends up getting either a pass, or a fail, and never in between. With the process that he created, the chances of winning a client is increased, resulting in higher close rates which lead to his consultancy earning the spot of “Top Done For You Agency.”

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